What the *discipline* is worth.

A market and pricing analysis for a product that sells drawdown control and behavioral protection — not headline returns. Two audiences, two anchors, one honest set of numbers.

RETAIL STANDARD	ADVISER LICENSE	BEHAVIOR GAP	WORST DRAWDOWN
$129/mo	$449/mo	1.2pp/yr	19%
$59 founding · $1,099/yr	Recommended · small firm, flat	Morningstar, 10y to 2024	21y walk-forward, backtested

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

One page, *six* conclusions.

The product changed; the pricing thesis has to change with it. RigaCap no longer sells a return story — it sells a 19% worst drawdown across 21 backtested years and a quantified answer to the question "will I actually stick with this?" That product prices against the cost of bad behavior, not against stock-pick newsletters.

01

Keep retail at $129/mo. Do not drift back toward $39.

$39 anchored RigaCap against Motley Fool ($99 first-year) and Zacks ($249/yr) — the mass pick-newsletter shelf. A drawdown-control product is only worth buying on a six-figure portfolio, where the behavior-gap math clears $129/mo with room to spare. The price is the positioning.

02

The value anchor is behavioral: ~2× the price on a $250k portfolio, ~8× at $1M.

Morningstar puts the investor behavior gap at ~1.22pp/yr over the decade to 2024; Vanguard values behavioral coaching at ~150bp/yr; DALBAR's single-year gaps run as high as 848bp. On $250k, 1.22pp is ~$3,050/yr against a $1,548/yr price. Breakeven portfolio at the Morningstar rate: ~$127k.

03 **Adviser tier: price as software-per-firm-size, never as basis points.**

The $399–499 flat hypothesis is right for solo-to-3-adviser firms and underpriced above that. Recommended: $449/mo (1–3 advisers), $899/mo (4–10), custom above — annual-first. AUM-linked pricing would walk the product toward sub-advisory optics and out of the publisher's exemption; flat licensing keeps the legal posture clean.

04 **One retained client funds the adviser license for a year.**

A $500k client at a 1% AUM fee is $5,000/yr; the recommended small-firm license is $5,388/yr. Vanguard's own framework says behavioral coaching is the largest single component of advisory value. The sale is client retention through drawdowns, not alpha.

05 **Pricing conflicts are live on the website today.**

The production landing page still displays $39/mo and $349/yr while investor-report-v2 states $129/$59-founding/$1,099. Four documents plus the live frontend disagree. Reconciliation list in Section 06 — this should be fixed before any adviser or investor sees both.

06 **The honest moat is the honesty.**

Signals are copyable and the live record is days old. What competitors cannot cheaply replicate: a 21-year continuous walk-forward with disclosed caveats, a quantified behavioral stress test, and a cost structure with no custody, no discretion, and no per-client compliance burden. Price for the discipline; let the live book earn the rest.

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The product we are *pricing* now.

The April 2026 pricing analysis priced a stock-pick newsletter. That product no longer exists. What exists in June 2026 is a momentum signal service whose core value proposition is drawdown control and behavioral protection — and the pricing logic has to be rebuilt from that premise.

The canon numbers (all backtested).

SERIES, 2007–2026 (PRICE RETURNS)	ANN. RETURN	SHARPE	WORST DRAWDOWN
RigaCap (continuous walk-forward, backtested)	8.3%	0.73	−19%
Raw 12-mo momentum (net, backtested)	13.2%	—	−57%
S&P 500 (price)	*9.8%*	—	*−55%*

Single continuous walk-forward path through 2008, COVID, and 2022. Backtested; no live capital over this window. Data 2016+ is survivorship-free; pre-2016 carries a disclosed survivorship caveat. Held-out last-24-months window: +32% annualized / 2.20 Sharpe / 8.5% drawdown (backtested). Monthly correlation to the S&P 500: 0.43. Live model book opens June 11, 2026 with a fresh $100k; everything prior is labeled backtest.

Read the table the way a buyer would. RigaCap's backtested 8.3% trails the index's 9.8% and trails raw momentum's 13.2%. If the pitch were return, the product would lose its own comparison table. The pitch is the third column: a worst drawdown of 19% across 21 years in which both alternatives lost more than half their value — and a behavioral claim built on it.

> **The behavioral stress test (backtested).** Model a $100k investor who panic-sells whenever their portfolio is down 25% from its peak. Under every re-entry rule tested, that investor collects **$473k from RigaCap** over the window — because the −25% tripwire never fires. The same investor in raw momentum finishes anywhere from **$206k to $1.02M** depending entirely on their nerve and re-entry timing; in the index, **$210k to $399k**. RigaCap's number is the only one that does not depend on the investor's behavior under stress. This is the product, quantified.

Two audiences, one engine.

AUDIENCE	WHAT THEY BUY	CURRENT PRICING
Self-directed retail (meaningful portfolios)	Daily signals, explicit sells, regime context, the discipline they cannot manufacture alone	$129/mo standard · $59/mo founding (first 100) · $1,099/yr
Registered investment advisers (firm license)	Internal-use research license: signals + regime engine applied across client accounts at the adviser's discretion	TBD — working hypothesis $399–499/mo flat; pressure-tested in Section 05

Legal posture constrains pricing design.

RigaCap operates under the Investment Advisers Act §202(a)(11)(D) publisher's exemption: impersonal signals, regular circulation, no custody, no discretion, no personalized advice. The adviser channel must remain an **internal-use research license** — the adviser reads the research and makes their own decisions for their clients. Two pricing structures would undermine that posture and are ruled out by construction:

- AUM-linked (basis-point) pricing. Charging on assets makes the economic relationship look like sub-advisory or model-provider compensation, the exact categories the license must avoid.

- **Per-client or per-account pricing.** Metering by the adviser's clients implies the service is delivered to those clients rather than to the firm.

Flat firm licensing, banded by adviser headcount, is the structure that prices the channel without touching the exemption. This constraint turns out to be commercially convenient — Section 03 shows the adviser-software market already prices this way.

Signals & newsletters — *the shelf* RigaCap sits on.

The retail market for paid stock research is large, mature, and priced in three distinct bands. Knowing which band you are in matters more than where you sit within it.

Current competitor pricing.

SERVICE	LIST PRICE	EFF. MONTHLY	NOTES (AS OF JUNE 10, 2026)
Motley Fool Stock Advisor	$199/yr ($99 intro)	$8–17	500k+ subs; buy-and-hold picks; no sells, no risk framework
Zacks Premium	$249/yr	~$21	Rank system; research breadth, no portfolio discipline
Seeking Alpha Premium	$299/yr ($225 promo)	~$25	Research platform, not a signal service
Motley Fool Epic	$499/yr ($299 intro)	$25–42	Bundle of four pick services
Seeking Alpha Alpha Picks	$499/yr ($375 promo)	$31–42	Quant picks; markets raw return (+405% claimed since 2022); no drawdown story

SERVICE	LIST PRICE	EFF. MONTHLY	NOTES (AS OF JUNE 10, 2026)
Mindful Trader	$47/mo	$47	Swing-trade alerts, radical transparency, ~3k members
IBD Leaderboard	$699/yr or $69/mo	$58–69	CAN SLIM growth list with entry/exit annotations
RigaCap (standard)	**$129/mo · $1,099/yr**	**$92–129**	**Signals + explicit sells + regime engine; 19% worst DD across 21y (backtested)**
Trade Ideas (TI Premium)	$254/mo ($178 annual rate)	$178–254	AI scanner platform for active day traders
Motley Fool Epic Plus	$1,999/yr ($1,399 intro)	$117–167	Top retail tier of the largest publisher
Zacks Ultimate	$2,995/yr	~$250	All Zacks portfolios; the brand's ceiling tier
Seeking Alpha Pro	$2,400/yr ($1,800 promo)	$150–200	Pro/semi-institutional research tier

Prices gathered by web research June 10, 2026; intro/promo prices noted where the vendor leads with them. All RigaCap performance figures are backtested.

Three price bands, three different products.

$8–42/mo — the pick shelf

Motley Fool, Zacks, Alpha Picks. Mass-market, return-marketed, sold on intro discounts and churned hard. Buyers here shop on headline performance claims. RigaCap loses this comparison on its own honest numbers — and should not be on this shelf.

$47–130/mo — the discipline shelf

Mindful Trader, IBD Leaderboard, RigaCap. Smaller audiences, explicit methodology, sell rules, transparency as the brand. Buyers here have real portfolios and have usually been burned once. This is RigaCap's band.

$150–250/mo — the platform shelf

Trade Ideas, Zacks Ultimate, SA Pro, Epic Plus. Tools and firehoses for very active traders. Validates that retail individuals routinely pay $1,800–3,000/yr — the ceiling is far above $129/mo.

~$30–40/mo — the quant-DIY corner

Allocate Smartly ("about $1 a day") tracks tactical asset-allocation strategies with drawdown and Ulcer-Index stats — the closest philosophical neighbor. But it is an ETF-allocation research tool for DIY quants, not a stock signal service with sells.

Where drawdown-first positioning sits today: almost nowhere.

Surveying the retail shelf, nobody leads with "you will actually stick with this." Alpha Picks markets cumulative return. Motley Fool markets its winners. IBD markets methodology. The only places behavioral framing is sold explicitly are (a) Allocate Smartly's tactical-allocation corner, which is asset-allocation research rather than equity signals, and (b) the *adviser* market, where Nitrogen (née Riskalyze) built a $99–450/mo per-seat business on aligning portfolios to client risk tolerance so clients don't bolt. The behavioral frame is proven willingness-to-pay — but it has been sold to advisers, not directly to retail. RigaCap's retail positioning is genuinely open ground.

> *Nobody on the retail shelf sells the ability to hold on. That is either an open market or a hard education problem — in practice, both.*

Honest market sizing.

The April document claimed a $2.5–6.5B TAM. That number described the entire paid-research market, most of which shops on return claims RigaCap deliberately refuses to make. The honest serviceable market is narrower: US self-directed investors with roughly $100k+ in equities who already pay for research *and* who can be persuaded to buy risk discipline over return promises. Reference points: Motley Fool alone holds 500k+ paid subscribers; single-author newsletters have reached 40k+ paid subscribers and $3M+ ARR; Alpha Picks built a large base in under four years inside an existing platform. A defensible planning frame:

MILESTONE	RETAIL SUBS	BLENDED ARR/SUB	RETAIL ARR
Founding cohort full	100	$708 ($59/mo)	$71k
Year 1 credible	500	~$1,250	~$625k
Year 2–3	2,000	~$1,350	~$2.7M
Scale case	**5,000**	**~$1,400**	**~$7M**

Blended ARR assumes a mix of monthly, annual, and grandfathered founding seats. At $129/mo the 5,000-subscriber scale case is ~3× the ARR the same subscriber count produced under $39 pricing — the strongest practical argument for the repositioning.

What RIAs *already* pay for.

The adviser channel is not a bigger retail channel. It is a different market with different anchors: per-seat software, basis-point platforms, and — critically — free model portfolios subsidized by fund fees. RigaCap has to price between those forces.

The adviser's current spend, by category.

CATEGORY	REPRESENTATIVE PRICING	WHAT IT BUYS
Research/analytics terminals (YCharts)	$300–500/mo per seat	Data, charting, proposals; ~$50k/yr for a 10-adviser firm
Portfolio analytics (Kwanti)	Per-adviser license, volume discounts	Model analytics, client reporting
Risk-alignment software (Nitrogen)	$99–450/mo per seat ($395/mo Elite bundle)	Risk tolerance, proposals, behavioral client alignment
TAMPs (outsourced management)	20–100bp on AUM (next-gen 30–50bp)	Full outsourced models + admin; $100M AUM at 50bp = $500k/yr
Asset-manager model portfolios	Often free	BlackRock/Vanguard/WisdomTree models, monetized via fund expense ratios

CATEGORY	REPRESENTATIVE PRICING	WHAT IT BUYS
Independent research shops	Hundreds to thousands $/yr (retail arms); institutional contracts five figures+	Hedgeye, Fundstrat/FS Insight, Ned Davis-class macro & strategy research

Pricing gathered by web research June 10, 2026. TAMP ranges per Kitces, Orion, and industry surveys.

Three implications for RigaCap's adviser tier.

3.1 **$399–499/mo is inside the proven software band, not above it.**

A solo adviser already pays Nitrogen up to $450/mo and YCharts up to $500/mo — per seat. A flat firm license at $449/mo prices like one more seat of standard adviser software. For a 5-adviser firm it is dramatically cheaper than any per-seat comparable. The hypothesis is not aggressive; if anything it leaves money on the table at the high end.

3.2 **Free model portfolios are the real competitor — and the real opening.**

Asset managers give allocation models away because the ETFs inside pay them. What they cannot give away is a tactical momentum sleeve with a 19% backtested worst drawdown, explicit sells, and a regime engine — free models are strategic-allocation products. RigaCap is not competing with free; it is the sleeve free models don't offer. The pitch: "your 5–10% satellite sleeve, with the drawdown discipline your clients' nerves require."

3.3 **TAMP basis points define the ceiling RigaCap must stay far below.**

At 30–100bp, a TAMP on a $50M book costs $150k–500k/yr — but delivers trading, custody integration, and administration. RigaCap delivers research only.

Staying flat-priced in the low thousands per year keeps the license an easy line-item approval (often below the threshold requiring partner sign-off) and reinforces that it is not asset management.

Market size, honestly.

There are roughly 15,000+ SEC-registered investment advisers plus a similar order of state-registered firms; the median firm is small (a handful of advisers). The realistic early market is the long tail: solo and small RIAs who cannot afford an in-house quant and who feel client-retention pain in every drawdown. One hundred small-firm licenses at $449/mo is ~$540k ARR — material against the retail base, achievable without enterprise sales motion. The constraint is trust-building time, not seat count: advisers will want to watch the live book before licensing it.

Two anchors, both *behavioral.*

A drawdown-control product is priced against the cost of bad behavior. That cost is among the best-documented numbers in retail finance — and it is large relative to both of RigaCap's price points.

The retail anchor: the behavior gap.

SOURCE	ESTIMATE	WINDOW
Morningstar “Mind the Gap”	~1.22pp/yr forfeited	10 years to Dec 2024 (~15% of total potential returns)
Vanguard Advisor's Alpha — behavioral coaching	~1.50pp/yr value	Largest single component of advisory value; “tens of percentage points” in panic years
DALBAR QAIB — single bad year	8.48pp gap (2024)	Avg. equity investor 16.54% vs S&P 25.05%; Guess Right Ratio at a record-low 25%
DALBAR QAIB — single calm year	0.72pp gap (2025)	Narrowest since 2012 — the gap is episodic, concentrated in stress years

As published; gathered June 10, 2026. DALBAR's methodology is debated — treat the 1.2–1.5pp structural estimates as the conservative planning numbers and the 8.5pp year as the tail event RigaCap is built for.

Convert the conservative estimate to dollars against the $1,548/yr standard price ($129 × 12):

EQUITY PORTFOLIO	BEHAVIOR COST @1.22PP/YR	MULTIPLE OF $1,548 PRICE
$100k	$1,220	0.8×
$250k	**$3,050**	**2.0×**
$500k	$6,100	3.9×
$1M	$12,200	7.9×

Breakeven portfolio: ~$127k at the Morningstar rate, ~$103k at the Vanguard rate. The product is rationally priced for portfolios of roughly $150k and up — which is exactly the buyer the positioning targets. Below $100k, $129/mo is genuinely expensive; the founding $59 seat and the annual price soften but do not eliminate that.

And the episodic framing is stronger than the annualized one. RigaCap's behavioral stress test (backtested) shows the panic-seller's outcome spread: $206k–$1.02M in raw momentum, $210k–$399k in the index, a single nerve-independent $473k in RigaCap. The buyer is not paying $1,548/yr for 122bp of average drag — they are paying to delete the left tail of their own behavior in the one year it matters. Insurance framing, with the premium an order of magnitude below the insured loss.

The adviser anchor: one retained client.

The adviser does not buy returns either — they buy client retention through drawdowns. The arithmetic is short:

$5,000/yr	$50k+	$5,388/yr
1% AUM FEE ON ONE $500K CLIENT	~LIFETIME REVENUE OF THAT CLIENT (10Y HORIZON)	RECOMMENDED SMALL-FIRM LICENSE ($449/MO)

If the regime engine and the drawdown story keep *one* $500k client from firing the firm in one bad year, the license pays for itself that year; the client's remaining lifetime is margin. Vanguard's framework makes the same argument from the other direction: behavioral coaching is the largest component of advisory value (~150bp), and a tool that arms the adviser's coaching conversation with a 21-year drawdown record (backtested, disclosed) is a direct input to that 150bp. Nitrogen built exactly this sale — risk alignment as client retention — into a per-seat business at $99–450/mo. RigaCap's adviser tier rides a willingness-to-pay that already exists.

> **The caveat that keeps us honest.** Both anchors assume the buyer believes the backtest. Until the live book (opened June 11, 2026) has quarters on it, the willingness-to-pay is theoretical for skeptics and real only for buyers who accept walk-forward methodology. Pricing should hold; *conversion* will lag price-justification until the live record exists. That is a marketing problem, not a pricing problem.

The *recommended* structure.

Hold the retail structure with two refinements. Build the adviser tier as flat, headcount-banded, annual-first firm licenses. Never price on assets.

Retail: hold $129, with discipline.

ELEMENT	VERDICT	REASONING
$129/mo standard	Keep.	Sits at the top of the discipline shelf ($47–130), well under the platform shelf ($150–250). Clears the behavior-gap value test 2–4× on the target $250k–$500k portfolio. The price itself filters for the buyer the product is honest for — a $39 price would re-attract small-portfolio return-shoppers who will churn on the first flat month.
$1,099/yr annual	Keep.	29% off monthly (~8.5 months) is richer than the 15–20% SaaS norm, but for a behavioral product the annual commitment IS the product — a subscriber locked in for 12 months cannot rage-quit the strategy in month three of a drawdown. Treat the extra discount as paying for retention and (honestly) for the commitment device. Push annual hard at checkout.

ELEMENT	VERDICT	REASONING
$59/mo founding, first 100	Keep; tighten mechanics.	Right price for buyers asked to trust a days-old live book. Make the scarcity real and visible: a public seat counter, lock-for-life framing ("founding rate never increases while you stay subscribed"), and a hard close at seat 100 with no silent extensions — an extended "limited" offer reads as a fake one and corrodes the honesty brand. Expect founding churn to be the lowest of any cohort; these are also the testimonial engine.
A cheaper paid tier (e.g., $39–49 "lite")	Reject.	It would split the audience, anchor the brand back to the pick shelf, and serve buyers for whom the math doesn't work. The correct low-end offer is *free*: the weekly regime report as the funnel (already in the growth plan), converting to one paid tier.
Price increase path	Plan, don't announce.	After 12 months of live record at or near the backtested risk profile, $149–179/mo is defensible against the same anchors. Grandfather existing subscribers; the founding cohort makes the "price only goes up" story credible from day one.

Adviser: flat firm licenses, banded by headcount.

TIER	ADVISERS	MONTHLY	ANNUAL (2 MO. FREE)
Firm — Small	**1–3**	**$449**	**$4,490**
Firm — Group	4–10	$899	$8,990
Firm — Enterprise	11+	Custom; floor ~$15k/yr	

Why these numbers.

- $449 splits the $399–499 hypothesis and prices one notch above Nitrogen's $395/mo Elite per-seat bundle — the closest behavioral-positioning comparable —

while the license covers up to three advisers. Per-adviser-equivalent cost at full utilization (~$150/mo) is roughly half of one Nitrogen seat and under a third of one YCharts Pro seat. Easy to approve, hard to call expensive.

- **The 4–10 band at $899 captures firm value without per-seat friction.** Headcount bands approximate per-seat economics with none of the metering, seat-audit, or compliance complexity. A 6-adviser firm at $899/mo pays ~$150/adviser — consistent with the small tier, double the absolute revenue.
- **Annual-first.** Advisers procure annually and churn decisions are made annually. Quote the annual price first; monthly exists as an on-ramp. Ten months for twelve mirrors the retail structure.
- **Flat, never bps** — the legal constraint from Section 01, restated as a sales feature: "we never touch your AUM economics; this is a research subscription, full stop."
- **What justifies ~3.5× retail:** firm-wide internal-use rights (retail is personal-use), a compliance-ready disclosure pack (methodology document, backtest provenance, survivorship caveats in citable form — an artifact retail doesn't need and advisers must have), adviser-facing regime commentary suitable for client conversations, and priority support. These are cheap to build and are the difference between "expensive retail account" and "firm license."

> **Founding-firm program (recommended).** Mirror the retail mechanics: first 10 firms at $299/mo (small tier) locked while subscribed, in exchange for a quarterly feedback call and permission to reference the relationship anonymously ("licensed by 10 RIA firms"). The adviser channel needs reference customers more than it needs the first $150/mo of margin, and the live-book trust deficit is largest exactly now.

Revenue outlook under the recommended structure.

End-of-year run-rate ARR by stream, base case. These are **targets conditional on distribution**, not forecasts — the live record began June 11, 2026, and Year 1 is constrained by reach, not pricing.

YEAR	RETAIL SUBS	RETAIL ARR	ADVISER FIRMS	ADVISER ARR	TOTAL ARR
Year 1	500	~$0.63M	10 (founding)	~$0.04M	~$0.67M
Year 2	2,000	~$2.8M	50	~$0.30M	~$3.1M
Year 3	~3,300	~$4.7M	~90	~$0.57M	~$5.3M
Year 5 (scale)	**5,000**	**~$7.0M**	**150**	**~$0.90M**	**~$7.9M**

Assumptions: retail blends to ~$1,400/sub/yr at steady state (mix of $129 monthly, $1,099 annual, grandfathered $59 founding seats; Year 1 blends ~$1,250 as founding seats dominate); adviser blends ~$6k/firm/yr ($449 small / $899 group / first ten at founding $299); churn inside the net counts (<5%/mo target); Year 3 interpolated between the 24-month and scale milestones.

Bands. Conservative (growth at half the curve — the live record converts slower): Y1 ~$0.3M · Y2 ~$1.4M · Y3 ~$2.4M · Y5 ~$3.7M. Upside (price step to $149–179 for new subscribers after 12 months of live record, plus a handful of 11+ adviser firms at the ~$15k floor): Y3 ~$6.5M · Y5 ~$9–10M.

Three structural reads matter more than the point estimates. **Retail carries the model** (~90% of scale ARR), but **the adviser dollar is the highest-leverage dollar** — ~10% of revenue from ~3% of customers, near-zero support load, and every firm markets the product to dozens of end clients at no acquisition cost; five 11+ firms roughly double the adviser line. **The Year 1→2 jump is the whole game** — it depends on the live record compounding with the marketing engine. And the 5,000-subscriber scale case is the same subscriber count that produced ~$2.3M under the old $39 pricing: the repositioning to the discipline shelf is worth ~3× revenue at identical scale.

Pricing conflicts to *reconcile.*

The repositioning left a trail of stale prices. One of them is live on the production website. Reconcile all of these to the $129 / $59-founding / $1,099 structure before any adviser, journalist, or investor sees two documents side by side.

LOCATION	STALE CONTENT	ACTION
`frontend/src/LandingPage.jsx` (LIVE SITE)	Displays $39/mo (line ~314) and $349/yr with "Save $119" (lines ~350–354)	Highest priority. The production landing page contradicts the stated pricing. Update to $129/$1,099 (or $59 founding presentation) and verify Stripe products/prices match what checkout actually charges.
`design/documents/rigacap-pricing-analysis.html`	Entire document priced at $39/mo · $349/yr; ARR table built on $39	Superseded by this document. Mark deprecated or delete; do not patch again.
`design/documents/rigacap-investor-report.html` (v1)	$39/month and $349/year in the pricing table (lines ~1097–1102)	v2 already carries $129/$59/$1,099. Retire v1 or clearly mark it superseded.
`design/documents/rigacap-marketing-playbook.html`	Persona copy: "Will pay $39/mo for a real edge" (line ~666); $349–468 LTV figure (line ~1044)	Rewrite persona willingness-to-pay and LTV math at $129/$1,099 (LTV roughly 3× the stated figure).

LOCATION	STALE CONTENT	ACTION
investor-report-v2 ($39 check)	No $39 found — v2 is clean ($129/$59/$1,099 at lines ~978–979). The remembered “$39 in investor-report” is in *v1* and the old pricing analysis.	No change needed in v2; confirm v2 is the only version circulated.

> **One structural note on the founding price.** $59 founding against $129 standard is a 54% discount — defensible only while the live record is thin. Documents should consistently frame it as compensation for early trust (“you are joining before the live record exists”), never as a sale. The two framings demand different copy, and only one of them survives the honesty positioning.

The *honest* section.

A pricing analysis that flatters the product misprices it. Here is what is defensible, what is not, and what each implies for price.

Defensible.

M1 **The 21-year honest backtest is expensive to fake and rare to find.**

A continuous walk-forward through 2008, COVID, and 2022, with disclosed survivorship caveats and no window-shopping, is methodologically out of reach of the marketing-led newsletter shelf — not because the math is hard, but because honest methodology produces un-marketable numbers (8.3% backtested vs the index's 9.8%) and almost nobody will publish that. The willingness to publish it IS the differentiation. Supports premium pricing with sophisticated buyers; does nothing for buyers who shop headline returns.

M2 **The behavioral quantification is original marketing IP.**

The panic-seller stress test ($473k nerve-independent vs $206k–$1.02M nerve-dependent, backtested) converts the abstract behavior-gap literature into a product-specific, reproducible number. Competitors can copy the idea, but each must run it against their own strategy — and a 57% drawdown strategy cannot survive the test. The test is a moat precisely for strategies that control drawdown.

M3 **The publisher-exemption cost structure compounds.**

No custody, no discretion, no per-client suitability, no sub-advisory agreements: gross margins are software margins and the adviser tier needs no broker-dealer infrastructure. Competitors who drift into model-marketplace or sub-advisory economics carry compliance costs RigaCap doesn't — structural room to underprice per unit of value, forever.

M4 **Explicit sells + regime engine remain near-unique on the retail shelf.**

The February competitive survey stands: of 30 surveyed services, none markets “when NOT to be in the market,” and most never issue a sell. This is a feature moat, not a structural one — but it has held for years because sell signals create accountability the pick-newsletter business model is built to avoid.

Not defensible.

R1 **The signals are copyable. One subscriber can rebroadcast everything.**

~20 positions rebalancing on a slow cadence is trivially shareable. Mitigation is partial at best: personal-use terms, watermarked content, and the practical truth that the freeloader forfeits the alerting, the regime context, and the discipline scaffolding — which for THIS product is most of the value. Accept leakage; price the experience, not the picks. (This also argues against any high-priced retail tier whose only content is the picks.)

R2 **The live record is days old. Every number above says “backtested.”**

The model book opened June 11, 2026. For 12–18 months the honest answer to “how has it done live?” is “ask me next year.” This caps conversion more than price; the founding mechanics (retail and adviser) exist precisely to pay early believers for this gap. The single worst thing for pricing power would be a live year that diverges badly from the backtested risk profile — the drawdown claim, not the return claim, is the one that must hold.

R3

The return story loses on its own table.

8.3% backtested vs 9.8% index: the buyer who frames this as a return product rationally indexes instead. The entire commercial thesis lives or dies on the buyer accepting the drawdown/behavior frame. That is an education-heavy, slower sale — reflected in this analysis as modest subscriber counts at premium prices rather than the inverse. If marketing reverts to return language under conversion pressure, the honest positioning collapses and the $129 price loses its logic.

R4

Concentration and key-man risk are unpriced.

One strategy, one operator, one (momentum) factor with documented crowding cycles. A multi-year momentum winter would test both audiences simultaneously. Diversification of the product line is a roadmap question, not a pricing one — but adviser buyers will ask, and the enterprise tier should not be promised continuity the operation cannot yet guarantee.

> *Price the experience and the discipline. The picks leak; the discipline doesn't.*

Sources & *disclosures.*

Competitor & market pricing (gathered June 10, 2026).

- Motley Fool Stock Advisor / Epic / Epic Plus pricing — fool.com service pages and 2026 third-party reviews (stockanalysis.com, traderhq.com, wallstreetzen.com).
- Seeking Alpha Premium / Alpha Picks / Pro — matchmybroker.com plan comparisons and moneysmylife.com promo trackers (June 2026 summer-sale pricing noted).
- Zacks Premium / Ultimate — zacks.com/products and 2026 reviews (stockanalysis.com, traderhq.com).
- IBD Leaderboard — traderhq.com 2026 review; investors.com.
- Trade Ideas — trade-ideas.com/pricing; stockbrokers.com 2026 review.
- Mindful Trader, Danelfin, AltIndex, LevelFields, Composer — RigaCap competitive-landscape survey (Feb 2026), spot-checked June 2026.
- Allocate Smartly — allocatesmartly.com (membership "about $1 a day"; drawdown/Ulcer-Index screener features).
- YCharts — G2/Capterra 2026 pricing pages ($300–500/mo per seat); koyfin.com RIA-alternatives analysis.
- Kwanti — kwanti.com/pricing (per-adviser licensing, volume discounts; rates not published).
- Nitrogen (Riskalyze) — nitrogenwealth.com/pricing and getpulsesignal.com ($99–450/mo plans; $395/mo Elite).
- TAMP fee ranges — kitces.com, orion.com, and 2026 TAMP guides (20–100bp; next-gen 30–50bp).
- Newsletter-market reference points — Motley Fool 500k+ subscribers (fool.com); solo-newsletter scale examples from 2025–26 trade press.

Behavioral-gap literature.

- Morningstar, "Mind the Gap" — ~1.22pp/yr investor behavior gap, 10 years to Dec 2024 (≈15% of potential returns forfeited).

- DALBAR QAIB 2025 — 2024 gap of 848bp (avg. equity investor 16.54% vs S&P 25.05%); Guess Right Ratio 25%; average equity-fund holding period 4.79 years.
- DALBAR QAIB 2026 — 2025 gap of 72bp (17.16% vs 17.88%), narrowest since 2012; the gap is episodic and stress-year concentrated.
- Vanguard Advisor's Alpha — behavioral coaching ~150bp/yr, the largest component of quantified advisory value; episodically far larger in panic years.

Performance disclosures. All RigaCap performance figures in this document — including the 8.3% annualized return, 0.73 Sharpe ratio, 19% worst drawdown (2007–2026 continuous walk-forward, price returns), the +32% annualized / 2.20 Sharpe / 8.5% drawdown last-24-months held-out window, the 0.43 monthly correlation to the S&P 500, and the behavioral stress-test outcomes ($473k vs comparator ranges) — are **backtested walk-forward results, not live trading results**. The live model book opened June 11, 2026 with a fresh $100,000; no performance prior to that date reflects live capital. Data from 2016 onward is survivorship-bias-free; pre-2016 data carries a disclosed survivorship caveat. Backtested performance has inherent limitations and does not guarantee future results. Comparator figures (raw 12-month momentum 13.2% net / 57% drawdown; S&P 500 9.8% / 55% drawdown) are from the same backtest framework over the same window.

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Document status. Internal strategy document. Competitor prices are list/promo prices observed via public web research on June 10, 2026 and change frequently. Supersedes *rigacap-pricing-analysis.html* (April 2026) in full.